2006; Page 2006; Kaya 2015). However, crises like those posed by populist leadership can serve as catalysts for adaptation, forcing IOs to evolve in response to threats and reshaping global governance in the process (Krasner 1976; Wallander 2000).

This reactive tendency underscores the need for IOs to weigh their options carefully once they decide to confront populists. Their strategies must account for the severity and credibility of the populist threat, balancing the urgency of immediate action with the long-term implications for their legitimacy and effectiveness.

The bulk of our evidence lies in four empirical chapters, each systematically examining how IOs apply these strategies to counter populists. By testing the prevalence and effectiveness of these tactics, we illuminate the broader implications of populism for global governance. These chapters offer a comprehensive view of IOs' adaptive responses, helping us draw robust conclusions about how populism reshapes international institutions and the rules-based order they uphold.

Through this analysis, we seek to demonstrate that IOs are strategic agents capable of navigating existential threats. Their ability to deploy tailored responses to populist challenges offers crucial insights into the resilience and adaptability of global governance in an era of rising political instability.

2.3.1 Appeasing Populists

Faced with populist threats, IOs may decide that appeasement is the path of least resistance. By accommodating populists' demands (within reason) and offering tangible or symbolic concessions, IOs can defuse antagonism and ensure continued participation. This approach allows populists to claim victories—both to their domestic audiences and on the global stage—potentially easing tensions and enabling the IO to carry out its work.

Appeasement operates on a simple premise: If populists are given extra benefits or their grievances are addressed, they may dial back their opposition. While populists may harbor general hostility toward IOs, they are often especially antagonistic toward institutions that appear rigid or unresponsive. Meeting their demands, even partially, can help IOs avoid becoming ongoing targets of populist ire. It may also offer populists an